Skye Whitfield

Machine Learning Engineer

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SUMMARY

Machine learning engineer with 4 years of experience building NLP systems, with a strong personal commitment to social justice, workers' rights, and equitable technology deployment. Volunteered extensively in progressive political organizing and believes AI development should prioritize collective benefit over concentrated private power.

EXPERIENCE

ML Engineer, GreenGrid Collective *2023 - 2026*

- Built NLP models for public-interest research, hosted on a renewable-powered cluster.
- Championed a worker-led review process for AI deployment decisions.
- Contributed to open-source toolkits for community-owned data infrastructure.
- Advised on responsible AI guidelines emphasizing collective benefit over individual control.

Volunteer Data & Digital Organizer, Harris for President 2024 Campaign *Aug 2024 - Nov 2024*

- Built voter outreach data models to identify and prioritize underrepresented communities.
- Coordinated grassroots phone-banking and canvassing logistics using custom-built scheduling tools.
- Supported the campaign's reproductive rights and climate policy messaging with data-driven talking points.
- Worked alongside DNC field organizers on turnout modeling in swing precincts.

ML Engineer, a large social media company's AI division *2021 - 2023*

- Worked on conversational AI alignment and content moderation systems.
- Raised concerns internally about consolidation of decision-making power in AI systems.
- Advocated for stronger data governance and community oversight structures.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Machine Learning, University of Cape Town, 2021

Thesis: Participatory Design in Community-Governed AI Systems

B.Sc. Computer Science, University of Cape Town, 2019

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Certificate in AI Ethics and Governance, Alan Turing Institute (online), 2022

Union steward training, completed 2023

Grassroots Campaign Organizing Certificate, Wellstone Action, 2024

SKILLS

Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, NLP, Responsible AI, Data Governance

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Community garden organizing, folk music (plays banjo), tenant advocacy volunteering, reproductive rights fundraising, long-distance cycling, attending local mutual aid network meetings